



P53 · 30 PAGES, PRINTABLE + FILLABLE

A Trimester-by-Trimester Emotional Companion

A thirty-page slow journal organized by trimester rather than by week. Five prompted pages per trimester focused on the feelings, the identity shifts, the pre-baby grief, the social changes, the body-as-experience instead of body-as-data. A quieter companion to the week-by-week journal. For the pregnant person who wants to write down what no medical chart tracks.

Soothemade Notes

A SMALL APOTHECARY OF PRINTABLES · MADE SLOWLY

A note before you start

Pregnancy planners mostly track the body. Weight. Symptoms. Appointments. Kicks. Weeks.

This one tracks the feelings.

You are doing something enormous. You are becoming a person you have not been before. You are grieving the version of you that fits in the small chair at the cafe, the one who could drink the second glass of wine, the one who slept through the night, the one who did not have to think about a body that is now two bodies.

You are also, possibly, excited. Curious. Tired in a new way. Bonded to a child you have not met. Scared. Hopeful. Sometimes all of that in one Tuesday afternoon.

The medical chart has no row for any of this. This journal does.

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This is a journaling companion, not therapy. If the feelings get heavier than journaling can hold (intrusive thoughts, persistent sadness, inability to function), please see a perinatal mental-health therapist. The “if you are not okay” page at the back has crisis lines.

How to use this companion

- Open it slowly. Each page has time built in.
- Five prompted pages per trimester. Do them in order, or skip around.
- Use a real pen, if you can. Typing is not the same.
- Some prompts are not answerable in one sitting. Come back.
- This is not a public-facing artifact. Write the honest thing.

This is the slow journal

A page to set the tone.

THE TWO JOURNALS

There is the journal where you write down what the OB said today.
There is this journal, where you write down what you have not said to anyone.

THE OPPOSITE OF EFFICIENCY

The fast journal is for tracking. This is for feeling. The fast journal helps you remember what week you are in. This helps you remember what it FELT like to be in that week.

A FEW GROUND RULES

- You can write something embarrassing.
- You can write something you would never say out loud.
- You can write a thing and then change your mind a week later.
- You can write the angry thing about your mother or your partner.
- You can write that you are not sure you want this.
- You can write that you are sure you do.
- Both can be true in different weeks.

A SMALL CEREMONY

Where I will keep this journal (somewhere private):

The time of day I am most likely to actually write in it:

The thing I want to remember to bring with me when I write
(a specific drink, a candle, a soft sweater, music):

Trimester One, page 1: the secret-keeping

DATE: _____ WEEK: _____

You are carrying news you have not told the world.

WHO KNOWS

The people I have told:

The people I am keeping it from, on purpose:

The people who I am not sure how to tell:

WHAT THE SECRET FEELS LIKE

In the morning: _____

At work: _____

In a social situation: _____

When I am alone: _____

THE STRANGEST PART OF THIS WEEK

ONE LINE I WOULD WHISPER TO THE BABY IF I COULD

Trimester One, page 2: the identity shift

DATE: _____ WEEK: _____

The first trimester is the most identity-disrupting before the body shows it. You know. They do not yet.

WHO I WAS, BEFORE THIS

The thing I most often did with my Saturdays:

The thing that defined my work / career:

The thing my friends knew me for:

WHO I AM BECOMING

The first thing about myself that has changed already:

The thing I am noticing I think about now that I never used to:

The version of me from a year ago, what would she think of this:

WHAT I AM NOT WILLING TO LOSE OF WHO I WAS

Trimester One, page 3: the body changes, from the inside

DATE: _____ WEEK: _____

The first trimester body is mostly invisible to others. To you, it is loud.

WHAT MY BODY IS DOING THAT NO ONE CAN SEE

WHAT MY BODY IS DOING THAT I AM SURPRISED BY

A MOMENT THIS WEEK WHEN I FELT BETRAYED BY MY BODY

A MOMENT THIS WEEK WHEN I FELT AWED BY MY BODY

WHAT I AM CRAVING

Food: _____

Sleep position: _____

Other: _____

WHAT I AM REPULSED BY

*Trimester One, page 4: what I am grieving
from before*

DATE: _____ WEEK: _____

You are gaining something. You are also losing something. Most pregnancy resources skip this part. The grief is real and is allowed.

THE VERSION OF MY LIFE THAT WILL NOT BE THE SAME

Things I will not do as easily, for a long time:

Things I will not do at all anymore:

The friendship that may not survive this transition:

The career trajectory I am pausing:

The traveling I had planned:

The body that is not coming back to exactly what it was:

WHAT I AM ALLOWED TO GRIEVE, EVEN WHILE BEING GRATEFUL

A NOTE: TWO TRUE THINGS AT ONCE

"I am happy to be having this baby."

"I am grieving the version of my life that is closing."

Both can be true. Most pregnant people who feel them both at once think they are wrong to. They are not. The grief is the cost of how full your life was before. It honors what you had.

Write to the version of yourself from six months ago. The one who did not yet know.

[illegible]

Trimester Two, page 1: going public

DATE: _____ WEEK: _____

The secret becomes visible. Strangers see what you have been holding privately for months. This shift is harder than it sounds.

THE FIRST PERSON OUTSIDE THE FAMILY TO NOTICE

Who: _____
How they noticed: _____
How I responded: _____

THE FIRST PERSON I TOLD WHO I HAD NOT PLANNED TO

Who: _____
Why I told them: _____

THE THING I FELT WHEN I FINALLY POSTED IT (if I did)

THE PEOPLE WHO REACTED IN A WAY I DID NOT EXPECT

THE COMMENTS THAT BOTHERED ME

WHAT I WISH PEOPLE WOULD STOP ASKING

ONE THING I AM PROUD OF, ABOUT HOW I HAVE HANDLED THE PUBLIC PART

Trimester Two, page 2: the social-life shifts

DATE: _____ WEEK: _____

The friendships start to sort themselves into who can hold this chapter and who cannot.

THE FRIENDS WHO ARE ASKING REAL QUESTIONS

THE FRIENDS WHO HAVE GONE QUIET

What I think is happening with them:

THE FRIENDS WHO ARE OVER-RESPONDING IN UNHELPFUL WAYS

NEW PEOPLE WHO ARE SHOWING UP

THE SOCIAL EVENTS I AM CHANGING MY RELATIONSHIP TO

- ☐ Drinking events (going, not going, going and not drinking)
- ☐ Late-night events
- ☐ Travel-heavy plans
- ☐ Active outings I used to do
- ☐ Other: _____

WHAT I MISS ABOUT MY OLD SOCIAL LIFE

WHAT I AM SURPRISED I AM ENJOYING ABOUT THE NEW SOCIAL LIFE

Trimester Two, page 3: the body is now visible

DATE: _____ WEEK: _____

The bump is real to other people. Strangers start commenting, touching, asking. This is a new layer of the experience.

THE FIRST STRANGER WHO COMMENTED

What they said: _____

How I felt: _____

What I said back: _____

THE FIRST STRANGER WHO TOUCHED THE BUMP

Where I was: _____

How I felt: _____

What I wished I had said: _____

WHAT I AM LEARNING ABOUT MY OWN BOUNDARIES

WHEN I FEEL BEAUTIFUL

WHEN I FEEL LIKE A BODY THAT EVERYONE HAS OPINIONS ABOUT

THE THING I WANT TO REMEMBER ABOUT MY PREGNANT BODY BEFORE IT IS NOT THIS BODY ANYMORE

Trimester Two, page 4: feeling the baby

DATE: _____ WEEK: _____

For most pregnant people, the second trimester is when movement becomes clear. The first kick is a small, private moment.

THE FIRST TIME I FELT MOVEMENT (or what I thought might be)

Date: _____

Where I was: _____

What it felt like: _____

WHEN THE MOVEMENT BECAME CLEAR

Date: _____

What the pattern is now:

WHEN THEY MOVE THE MOST

WHAT IT DOES TO ME EMOTIONALLY WHEN THEY MOVE

THE FIRST TIME SOMEONE ELSE FELT THEM FROM THE OUTSIDE

Who: _____

Their face when they felt it: _____

THE THING I WANT TO SAY TO THE BABY ABOUT THE MOVEMENT

*Trimester Two, page 5: what is becoming
real*

DATE: _____ WEEK: _____

The midpoint of pregnancy is often the first stretch where the baby feels real, not just abstract.

WHAT FEELS REAL NOW THAT DID NOT BEFORE

WHAT STILL FEELS UNREAL

THE NAME (if you are working on one)

What we are considering:

What the discussion has been like:

THE ROOM OR SPACE FOR THEM

What I am thinking about the physical setup:

THE THING I AM EXCITED ABOUT, AT THIS HALFWAY POINT

THE THING I AM STILL SCARED OF

Trimester Three, page 1: the waiting

DATE: _____ WEEK: _____

The third trimester is mostly waiting. The body has done most of the building. The mind is bracing.

WHAT THE WAITING FEELS LIKE

- ☐ Tense
- ☐ Sacred
- ☐ Boring
- ☐ Anxious
- ☐ Spacious
- ☐ Suffocating
- ☐ All of the above
- ☐ Other: _____

WHAT I AM DOING TO PASS THE TIME

WHAT I CANNOT DO ANYMORE

WHO IS CHECKING IN ON ME

WHO IS NOT CHECKING IN, WHO I WISH WAS

THE THING I AM MOST IMPATIENT FOR

THE THING I AM SAVORING ABOUT BEING THIS PREGNANT

Trimester Three, page 2: nesting examined

DATE: _____ WEEK: _____

"Nesting" is talked about as a cute pregnancy instinct. It is also sometimes a stress response.

WHAT I AM DOING IN THE HOUSE THAT WOULD COUNT AS NESTING

WHAT I AM AVOIDING DOING THAT I "SHOULD" BE DOING

THE THINGS I CARE ABOUT GETTING DONE BEFORE THE BABY ARRIVES

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

THE THINGS I HAVE ON MY LIST BUT DO NOT ACTUALLY CARE ABOUT

(Let those go.)

WHAT I AM PROCRASTINATING ABOUT, AND WHY

A NOTE: SOMETIMES NESTING IS JOY. SOMETIMES IT IS ANXIETY WEARING A CUTE OUTFIT. THE QUESTION IS WHETHER THE CLEANING IS GROUNDING YOU OR EXHAUSTING YOU. NOTICE WHICH.

Trimester Three, page 3: fear and joy

DATE: _____ WEEK: _____

Both are loud in the last trimester. Most pregnancy books cover one or the other. The truth is they sit in the same body, often in the same hour.

THE FEAR THAT IS LOUDEST RIGHT NOW

THE JOY THAT IS LOUDEST RIGHT NOW

THE THING I FEEL BUT DO NOT HAVE A WORD FOR

THE PERSON I WANT TO TELL THE FEAR TO

THE PERSON I WANT TO TELL THE JOY TO

(Often these are different people, and that is information.)

A SMALL PRACTICE

Right now, name one thing in the room that is true.

Both the fear and the joy will pass through. The thing in the room stays. Anchor there.

Trimester Three, page 4: "I miss being just me"

DATE: _____ WEEK: _____

Permission slip page.

THINGS ABOUT BEING JUST ME THAT I MISS

THINGS I DO NOT MISS

WHO I WAS BEFORE, IN ONE WORD

WHO I WILL BE AFTER, IN ONE WORD (best guess)

A REMINDER

You are not betraying the baby by missing your former life. You are allowed to grieve the small things (the late dinners, the quiet mornings, the long shower) and the big things (the freedom, the career stride, the marriage being just-the-two-of-you).

The version of you who misses these things is the same version who will love the baby. They are not in opposition. They share a body.

Trimester Three, page 5: what to remember

DATE: _____ WEEK: _____

You are at the end of this version of your life. Soon, you will be on the other side.

WHAT I WANT TO REMEMBER ABOUT BEING PREGNANT, WHEN I AM NO LONGER PREGNANT

The physical sensation I want to remember:

The view from the bath I want to remember:

The way my partner has been with me:

A specific morning that has felt like a small gift:

The way my body has surprised me:

The strangest dream I have had:

The thing I learned about myself in pregnancy that I did not know before:

A NOTE TO MY POSTPARTUM SELF

When you read this, the pregnancy is over. The baby is here. Some of it was hard. Some of it was wonderful. From here, on the last week of pregnancy, I want you to know:

THE LAST LINE I WROTE IN THIS JOURNAL BEFORE THE BABY CAME

If you are not okay

The companion is a journaling tool. It is not a substitute for mental-health care.

HONEST CHECK

Am I able to enjoy things that used to bring me joy?

☐ Yes ☐ Sometimes ☐ Not really

Am I sleeping?

☐ Yes ☐ Some ☐ No

Am I eating?

☐ Yes ☐ Some ☐ No

Am I having thoughts that are scaring me?

☐ No ☐ Yes

Am I avoiding prenatal care because of anxiety?

☐ No ☐ Yes

Has anyone close to me expressed concern about me?

☐ No ☐ Yes

If two or more of these point toward "not okay," see a perinatal mental-health professional. Perinatal depression and anxiety affect roughly 1 in 5 pregnant people. The treatment is good. The treatment is short. Pregnancy is not the time to wait it out.

CRISIS LINES

US, 988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline

US, Postpartum Support International HelpLine
1-833-852-6262

US, Maternal Mental Health Hotline: 1-833-943-5746

UK, Samaritans: 116 123

Canada, 9-8-8 Suicide Crisis Helpline

Australia, PANDA: 1300 726 306

THE PROVIDER I AM RESERVING

Name: _____
Phone: _____

A final letter

You wrote down what no chart tracks.

The feelings, the small moments, the version of yourself you noticed shifting, the friendships that bent under the weight of the change, the body becoming visible to strangers, the night the baby kicked and you knew, the morning you missed your old life.

In a year, you will read this and remember things you would have lost otherwise. The first cup of coffee you skipped. The friend who showed up. The hard week. The Saturday morning you wrote three pages and then napped.

This is not the journal that helps you remember what week you were in. It is the one that helps you remember what it **FELT** like to be in that week.

Both kinds of remembering matter. This one matters more, often, than the chart.

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Soothemade *Notes*

*Made for the version of you no one tells you about, the
one at four in the morning, the one in the parking lot, the
one who doesn't recognize her own week.*

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